



BenQ RD320U

Best monitor for coders?

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BenQ RD320U programming monitor is designed for people who spend hours in front of a screen coding. The priority for coders and programmers, as well as for the BenQ RD320U, is a screen that is easy on the eyes. BenQ tries to appeal to the target audience with connectivity options that hardcore developers would need, along with other custom hardware and software solutions like a function bar with a coding hotkey, PIP/PBP modes for multiple inputs, MoonHalo backlight to create a soothing work environment and more. But how much of a difference do these extras make? Do these features justify the high-end price? Let's try to answer that question and more in our BenQ RD320U review.

Display quality and colour modes

To start with, the RD320U uses an IPS

Black panel. This means you get the advantages of IPS displays like wide viewing angles along with higher contrast. The display has an anti-reflective Nano Matte finish panel that minimises glare and makes the display comfortable to use for long hours.

Another highlight of the monitor is the Coding Modes and a Coding Hotkey to switch between them. There is a dark theme suited for coding editors most of which come with a black background. Blacks in the Dark Coding Theme are extremely deep which is achieved by adapting an aggressive tone curve.

If you use this mode to watch movies and other content, you will notice that shadow details are crushed. There is also a light coding theme. Apart from blacks, the mode also enables sharper fonts and improved code differentiation to be easy on the eyes. Coding Light theme undertracks the gamma curve but has a warmer

white point and is more suitable for those who prefer a Light theme or more whites.

There is a Mbook mode for colour consistency with Apple Macbooks and a warm, monochrome Epaper mode that is easy on the eyes for readers.

The most colour-accurate mode, the sRGB mode where we recorded the maximum contrast of 1952:1 and an average white point close to standard D65.

This monitor is not meant to be highly colour-accurate out of the box, but the colour credentials are quite decent. We recorded 100% sRGB and 98.7% DCI-P3 coverage.

Colour volume that measures the range of colours a display can reproduce at different luminance levels turned out better than expected. The display can reproduce 94% of DCI-P3 colour volume and 100% of sRGB colour volume.

As for colour accuracy, we recorded an average delta error of 2.4. The HDR mode is even more accurate with an average delta error of less than 2. The display has a peak brightness of approximately 300 nits which isn't high enough for impactful HDR but is still quite decent for a monitor.

Coding features

Apart from the Coding Modes that we discussed in the last section, there are several other features that should perhaps make the monitor appealing to coders and programmers.

The main highlight and differentiation factor is the Function Bar which includes a Coding Hotkey, a customizable Function key and LED indicators.

The Coding Hotkey is a touch button to toggle Coding colour modes on the monitor. The customisable Function Key can be assigned to functions such as colour mode, Signal input and more.

There is also an Eye Reminder feature that uses an IR sensor to detect how long you have been sitting in front of the screen. It pushes a notification in the right corner after a set time when it's time to take a break. The notification is easy to miss if you use the RD320U as an extended monitor.